



"Long live the victory of Chairman Mao's Revolution"

In a typical piece of propaganda, this celebration of the leadership of Mao Zedong, produced for the 50th anniversary of the creation of the Chinese Communist Party, shows him surrounded by adoring supporters.

perpetrated a massacre of around 300,000 men, women, and children that became known as the Rape of Nanjing. The Nationalist government relocated 1,000 miles (1,600 km) up the Yangzi River, while the Communists operated behind Japanese lines.

Civil war and communist victory

With the Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor in 1941 (see pp.402–03), the Sino-Japanese hostilities became absorbed in the wider conflict of World War II, and Japan was ultimately defeated by the Allies. By July 1946, another civil war in China had broken out. While the Nationalist government was being seriously damaged by galloping inflation, the Communists were gaining rural support with revolutionary land reform in favor of the peasants. Manchuria fell to the Communists, and when, in January 1949, around 300,000 Nationalists surrendered, Mao's troops marched triumphantly into

Beijing. On October 1, 1949 the communist People's Republic of China (PRC) was established. Jiang Jieshi and two million of his supporters fled to the island of Taiwan, where they established the rival Republic of China.

Consolidation

The People's Republic then occupied all territory claimed by China, including Tibet. Mao negotiated the Sino-Soviet Treaty of Alliance and Mutual Assistance and, in 1950, when the Korean War broke out (see pp.406–07) China intervened on the side of North Korea. In China, the First Five Year

CHINESE COMMUNIST LEADER (1893–1976)

MAO ZEDONG

The son of a rich peasant, Mao moved to Beijing from Hunan province at the time of the May Fourth Movement (see BEFORE), where he first encountered communist ideas. He joined the Chinese Communist Party at its inception in 1921, taking control in 1935 after proving his leadership during the Long March. As head of the country from 1949 until his death in 1976, Mao's attempts to implement his radical ideas led to disastrous famines. However, "Mao Zedong Thought" had far-reaching effects, and after his death the Party declared that it would remain "a guide to action for a long time to come."



Mao's "little red book"

"Father is close, mother is close, but neither is as close as Chairman Mao." 900 million copies of *Quotations from Chairman Mao* were printed.

Plan, launched in 1953 with Soviet assistance, achieved spectacular increases in industrial output. Reforms banned arranged marriages, and the subjugation of women. Farming was collectivized, so peasants handed over their land to agricultural producers' cooperatives.

The radical years

In 1958, Mao Zedong introduced the radical policy known as the Great Leap Forward. Industrial and agricultural cooperatives were amalgamated into communes—with collective kitchens and daycares—and industrial targets were raised. At first it seemed as if spectacular increases of

output had been achieved, but later evidence showed that these policies had caused disastrous famines and the death of millions of people. In 1966, the Cultural Revolution was launched, with the aim of cleansing the country of "bourgeois" influences. Children were recruited as Red Guards and, to rekindle the spirit of revolution, were encouraged to report their schoolteachers and relatives if they failed to display sufficient communist fervor. Brandishing their "little red books" (see above) the Red Guards attacked the Four Olds: old ideas, old culture, old customs, and old habits.

AFTER

China's Cultural Revolution saw millions "reeducated" through forced labor and thousands executed. The terror did not end until the arrest of the Gang of Four in 1976.

GANG OF FOUR

Mao's wife **Jiang Qing**, party chief **Zhang Chunqiao**, critic **Yao Wenyuan**, and **Wang Hongwen**, a factory worker, expected to succeed Mao after his death. Instead, they were **arrested**, and found guilty of **plotting to seize power**.

THE FOUR MODERNIZATIONS

In 1978, Premier Deng Xiaoping announced the modernization of agriculture, industry, science, and defense, to make China a **great economic power** by the early 21st century **472–73** >>

TIANANMEN SQUARE

When **pro-democracy** students demonstrated in Tiananmen Square, Beijing, Premier Li Peng instructed the army to act. On June 4, 1989, troops opened fire on the protesters, killing 400–800.



TIANANMEN SQUARE PROTESTER DEFIES TANKS

more than 80,000 soldiers and workers northwest through harsh terrain, fighting the Nationalists all the way. By the time they established headquarters at Yan'an in October 1935, only about 8,000 of the original marchers had survived, and Mao had taken command of the Communist Party.

War with Japan

Japanese encroachment on Chinese territory had begun in 1931 with the seizure of Manchuria. In 1937, Japanese forces invaded China and

China under Mao

A clever military strategist and propagandist, Mao's ruthless policies had a dramatic effect on China's economy and society.

1946 Chinese civil war. The Nationalist government struggles to control the economy as Mao's forces use guerrilla tactics.

1949 People's Republic of China proclaimed, with Mao Zedong leader of the Communist Party.

1963 Madame Mao, Chairman Mao's fourth wife, becomes politically active and begins to stage propagandist operas, ballets, and plays.

1968 The country is on the brink of anarchy. Mao restores control by disbanding the Red Guard units and creating new **Revolutionary Committees**.

1976 Death of Mao and the end of the Cultural Revolution.

